

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Globalisation and Challenges to Sovereignty - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Globalisation and Challenges to Sovereignty

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 External Sovereignty and the Central Problem

2 Definitions and the Chapter Sequence

3 Core Distinctions and Thinkers

4 Historical Illustrations and Comparative Effects

5 Trap Repair, Boundaries, Revision and Sources

6 Theses and Directive Decoding

7 Constraint Mechanisms and the Objection-Reply Chain

8 Named Evidence Units

9 Worked Analysis and Mark-Scaled Architecture

10 Indian Application and Proposition Method

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Globalisation and Challenges to Sovereignty - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g2 **PYQ ownership:** No directly owned verified PYQ is assigned to this topic; all questions below are original practice.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Imperialism**?

A. domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210). B. relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF p.217). C. a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212). D. pressure on sovereignty changes how it operates; it does not automatically dissolve the state as a legal actor.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Imperialism** with **domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

A metropolitan centre dominates distant territories without direct settlement being necessary. Which concept is broad enough to cover this relation?

A. Edward Said B. Imperialism C. State D. Neo-colonialism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210)**, with **Imperialism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Colonialism**?

A. two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright. B. international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states (read with Gauba's external challenge framing in PDF pp.209, 212-218). C. implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209). D. Policy autonomy narrows under IMF/World Bank conditionality, WTO treaty commitments and delegated adjudicative procedures; regulatory functions may also be pooled in common institutions (PDF pp.216-217 for IMF/World Bank).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Colonialism** with **implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Foreign settlement and direct territorial rule are the defining features of which form of domination?

A. J.A. Hobson B. Market C. Power blocs D. Colonialism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209)**, with **Colonialism**. The other options are valid source terms or

statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Neo-colonialism**?

A. formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212). B. Gauba's own text names these as the "Western-dominated agencies" whose loan/structural-adjustment terms and conditions developing countries are said to accept under globalisation (PDF pp.216-217, IMF concessional assistance discussed at p.217). This is a consented but often unequal external constraint, not delegation: the borrowing state accepts conditions attached to finance, but the lender does not thereby exercise a defined sovereign function on the state's behalf. C. the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212). D. interprets imperialism as a search for captive markets and attacks it as exploitation (PDF p.210).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Neo-colonialism** with **formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms** (PDF pp.210-212). The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

A formally independent state remains dependent on external finance, prices, technology and corporate power. Which concept best explains this?

A. Lenin B. Neo-colonialism C. Citizenship D. Globalization

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms** (PDF pp.210-212), with **Neo-colonialism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Power blocs**?

A. already named in Gauba's neo-colonialism discussion as vehicles of capital investment, cheap-labour use and profit repatriation that narrow a developing state's practical economic autonomy even after formal independence (PDF pp.210-212). B. one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological, environmental and cultural linkage (PDF pp.212-218). C. Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214). D. sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Power blocs** with **Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action** (PDF pp.212-214). The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

A weaker state retains legal independence but faces military and diplomatic pressure to follow a superpower camp. Which concept applies?

A. Kwame Nkrumah B. Imperialism C. Liberalization / privatization D. Power blocs

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action** (PDF pp.212-214), with **Power blocs**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Globalization**?

A. worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as a conscious policy linked to liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217). B. treaty negotiation and collective rule-making contain a pooled element, while authorising panels or adjudicators to apply agreed rules is a delegated element. Both rest on consented treaty commitments rather than unilateral external command. Verify the current operational status of particular dispute-settlement stages from an official WTO source before making a dated claim; do not present this illustration as a Gauba citation. C. Nkrumah popularised and systematised neo-colonialism for an international audience in his 1965 book Neo-colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism, explaining how formal independence may coexist with continued external control through international monetary bodies, world-market price-fixing, multinational corporations/cartels, and educational-cultural institutions (PDF pp.211-212). D. domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Globalization** with **worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as a conscious policy linked to liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Production, finance, communication, culture and environmental effects become increasingly interconnected across borders. Which concept names this process?

A. Gauba's balanced appraisal B. Globalization C. Colonialism D. Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba)

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as a conscious policy linked to liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217)** with **Globalization**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Liberalization / privatization**?

A. a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212). B. pressure on sovereignty changes how it operates; it does not automatically dissolve the state as a legal actor. C. relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF p.217). D. globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberalization / privatization** with **relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF p.217)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

A government deliberately relaxes economic controls and transfers state enterprises to private ownership. Which policy pair is involved?

A. State B. Neo-colonialism C. IMF and World Bank D. Liberalization / privatization

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF**

p.217). with **Liberalization / privatization**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba)**?

A. two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright. B. helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209). C. formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212). D. the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba)** with **two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which analytical distinction separates joint institutional decision-making from authorising a body to perform a defined adjudicative or administrative function?

A. Market B. Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba) C. Power blocs D. Multinational Corporations (MNCs)

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright** with **Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **IMF and World Bank**?

A. the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212). B. interprets imperialism as a search for captive markets and attacks it as exploitation (PDF p.210). C. Gauba's own text names these as the "Western-dominated agencies" whose loan/structural-adjustment terms and conditions developing countries are said to accept under globalisation (PDF pp.216-217, IMF concessional assistance discussed at p.217). This is a consented but often unequal external constraint, not delegation: the borrowing state accepts conditions attached to finance, but the lender does not thereby exercise a defined sovereign function on the state's behalf. D. Production, capital and labour cross borders through MNCs, eroding a state's exclusive control over its own economic space (PDF pp.210-212, 214-217).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **IMF and World Bank** with **Gauba's own text names these as the "Western-dominated agencies" whose loan/structural-adjustment terms and conditions developing countries are said to accept under globalisation (PDF pp.216-217, IMF concessional assistance discussed at p.217). This is a consented but often unequal external constraint, not delegation: the borrowing state accepts conditions attached to finance, but the lender does not thereby exercise a defined sovereign function on the state's behalf**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which institutions are the relevant example when a state accepts financing conditions that constrain policy but do not delegate a sovereign function?

A. Citizenship B. Globalization C. World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text) D. IMF and World Bank

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba's own text names these as the "Western-dominated agencies" whose loan/structural-adjustment terms and conditions developing countries are said to accept under globalisation (PDF pp.216-217, IMF concessional assistance discussed at p.217). This is a consented but often unequal external constraint, not delegation: the borrowing state accepts conditions attached to finance, but the lender does not thereby exercise a defined sovereign function on the state's behalf. with IMF and World Bank.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Multinational Corporations (MNCs)**?

A. already named in Gauba's neo-colonialism discussion as vehicles of capital investment, cheap-labour use and profit repatriation that narrow a developing state's practical economic autonomy even after formal independence (PDF pp.210-212). B. one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological, environmental and cultural linkage (PDF pp.212-218). C. sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210). D. Global communication, migration and transnational civil-society networks widen a citizen's frame of reference and rights-claims beyond the territorial state (synthesis, not a direct Gauba citation).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Multinational Corporations (MNCs)** with **already named in Gauba's neo-colonialism discussion as vehicles of capital investment, cheap-labour use and profit repatriation that narrow a developing state's practical economic autonomy even after formal independence (PDF pp.210-212).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which actors can narrow practical autonomy through investment control, labour-location choices and profit repatriation without becoming states?

A. Imperialism B. Multinational Corporations (MNCs) C. Liberalization / privatization D. Formal independence vs effective autonomy

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **already named in Gauba's neo-colonialism discussion as vehicles of capital investment, cheap-labour use and profit repatriation that narrow a developing state's practical economic autonomy even after formal independence (PDF pp.210-212).** with **Multinational Corporations (MNCs).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **World Trade Organization (WTO)** (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text)?

A. a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212). B. pressure on sovereignty changes how it operates; it does not automatically dissolve the state as a legal actor. C. treaty negotiation and collective rule-making contain a pooled element, while authorising panels or adjudicators to apply agreed rules is a delegated element. Both rest on consented treaty commitments rather than unilateral external command. Verify the current operational status of particular dispute-settlement stages from an official WTO source before making a dated claim; do not present this illustration as a Gauba citation. D. globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text)** with **treaty negotiation and collective rule-making contain a pooled element, while authorising panels or adjudicators to apply agreed rules is a delegated element. Both rest on consented treaty commitments rather than unilateral external command. Verify the current operational status of particular dispute-settlement stages from an official WTO source before making a dated claim; do not present this illustration as a Gauba citation.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which institution illustrates pooled treaty rule-making together with delegated application of agreed trade rules?

A. Colonialism B. Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba) C. Legal sovereignty vs actual power D. World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text)

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **treaty negotiation and collective rule-making contain a pooled element, while authorising panels or adjudicators to apply agreed rules is a delegated element. Both rest on consented treaty commitments rather than unilateral external command. Verify the current operational status of particular dispute-settlement stages from an official WTO source before making a dated claim; do not present this illustration as a Gauba citation.** with **World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Formal independence vs effective autonomy**?

A. a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212). B. pressure on sovereignty changes how it operates; it does not automatically dissolve the state as a legal actor. C. globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218). D. implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Formal independence vs effective autonomy** with **a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which distinction explains why recognised statehood can coexist with severe material dependence?

A. Neo-colonialism B. Formal independence vs effective autonomy C. IMF and World Bank D. Imperialism vs neo-colonialism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212)** with **Formal independence vs effective autonomy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Legal sovereignty vs actual power**?

A. helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209). B. Policy autonomy narrows under IMF/World Bank conditionality, WTO treaty commitments and delegated adjudicative procedures; regulatory functions may also be pooled in common institutions (PDF pp.216-217 for IMF/World Bank). C. international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states (read with Gauba's external challenge framing in PDF pp.209, 212-218). D. formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Legal sovereignty vs actual power** with **international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states** (read with Gauba's external challenge framing in PDF pp.209, 212-218). The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which distinction contrasts juridical equality with unequal administrative, economic and strategic capability?

A. Power blocs B. Multinational Corporations (MNCs) C. Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence D. Legal sovereignty vs actual power

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states** (read with Gauba's external challenge framing in PDF pp.209, 212-218). with **Legal sovereignty vs actual power**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Imperialism vs neo-colonialism**?

A. the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212). B. Production, capital and labour cross borders through MNCs, eroding a state's exclusive control over its own economic space (PDF pp.210-212, 214-217). C. Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214). D. one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological, environmental and cultural linkage (PDF pp.212-218).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Imperialism vs neo-colonialism** with **the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence** (PDF pp.209-212). The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which comparison separates direct or overarching domination from post-independence control through indirect dependency?

A. Globalization B. Imperialism vs neo-colonialism C. World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text) D. Globalization as process vs globalization as policy

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence** (PDF pp.209-212). with **Imperialism vs neo-colonialism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence**?

A. sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210). B. treaty negotiation and collective rule-making contain a pooled element, while authorising panels or adjudicators to apply agreed rules is a delegated element. Both rest on consented treaty commitments rather than unilateral external command. Verify the current operational status of particular dispute-settlement stages from an official WTO source before making a dated claim; do not present this illustration as a Gauba citation. C. one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological, environmental and cultural linkage (PDF pp.212-218). D. Nkrumah popularised and systematised neo-colonialism for an international audience in his 1965 book Neo-colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism, explaining how formal independence may coexist with continued external control through international monetary bodies, world-market price-fixing, multinational corporations/cartels, and educational-cultural institutions (PDF pp.211-212).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence** with **one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological, environmental and cultural linkage** (PDF pp.212-218). The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which comparison separates bipolar strategic compulsion from broader economic, technological and ecological linkage?

A. Liberalization / privatization B. Formal independence vs effective autonomy C. Constraint vs disappearance D. Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological, environmental and cultural linkage** (PDF pp.212-218). with **Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Globalization as process vs globalization as policy**?

A. Gauba treats interdependence as an emerging reality and also describes policy globalization as a deliberate extension of liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217). B. Nkrumah popularised and systematised neo-colonialism for an international audience in his 1965 book Neo-colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism, explaining how formal independence may coexist with continued external control through international monetary bodies, world-market price-fixing, multinational corporations/cartels, and educational-cultural institutions (PDF pp.211-212). C. domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210). D. a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Globalization as process vs globalization as policy** with **Gauba treats interdependence as an emerging reality and also describes policy globalization as a deliberate extension of liberalization and privatization** (PDF pp.214-217). The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which distinction separates cross-border structural change from deliberate liberalising choices by governments?

A. Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba) B. Globalization as process vs globalization as policy C. Legal sovereignty vs actual power D. Edward Said

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba treats interdependence as an emerging reality and also describes policy globalization as a deliberate extension of liberalization and privatization** (PDF pp.214-217).

with **Globalization as process vs globalization as policy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Constraint vs disappearance**?

A. globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218). B. implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209). C. pressure on sovereignty changes how it operates; it does not automatically dissolve the state as a legal actor. D. two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Constraint vs disappearance** with **pressure on sovereignty changes how it operates; it does not automatically dissolve the state as a legal actor**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which distinction prevents reduced policy space from being mistaken for the extinction of the state as a legal actor?

A. IMF and World Bank B. Imperialism vs neo-colonialism C. J.A. Hobson D. Constraint vs disappearance

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **pressure on sovereignty changes how it operates; it does not automatically dissolve the state as a legal actor** with **Constraint vs disappearance**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Edward Said**?

A. helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209). B. Policy autonomy narrows under IMF/World Bank conditionality, WTO treaty commitments and delegated adjudicative procedures; regulatory functions may also be pooled in common institutions (PDF pp.216-217 for IMF/World Bank). C. formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212). D. the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Edward Said** with **helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which thinker is used here to distinguish broad imperial domination from settlement-based colonialism?

A. Multinational Corporations (MNCs) B. Edward Said C. Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence D. Lenin

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209)** with **Edward Said**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **J.A. Hobson**?

A. Production, capital and labour cross borders through MNCs, eroding a state's exclusive control over its own economic space (PDF pp.210-212, 214-217). B. Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214). C. interprets imperialism as a search for captive markets and attacks it as exploitation (PDF p.210). D. already named in Gauba's neo-colonialism discussion as vehicles of capital investment, cheap-labour use and profit repatriation that narrow a developing state's practical economic autonomy even after formal independence (PDF pp.210-212).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **J.A. Hobson** with **interprets imperialism as a search for captive markets and attacks it as exploitation (PDF p.210)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which thinker explains imperialism through captive markets and condemns it as exploitation?

A. World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text) B. Globalization as process vs globalization as policy C. Kwame Nkrumah D. J.A. Hobson

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **interprets imperialism as a search for captive markets and attacks it as exploitation (PDF p.210)**, with **J.A. Hobson**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Lenin**?

A. sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210). B. Global communication, migration and transnational civil-society networks widen a citizen's frame of reference and rights-claims beyond the territorial state (synthesis, not a direct Gauba citation). C. worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as a conscious policy linked to liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217). D. treaty negotiation and collective rule-making contain a pooled element, while authorising panels or adjudicators to apply agreed rules is a delegated element. Both rest on consented treaty commitments rather than unilateral external command. Verify the current operational status of particular dispute-settlement stages from an official WTO source before making a dated claim; do not present this illustration as a Gauba citation.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Lenin** with **sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which thinker links imperialism to capitalist expansion for markets, investment outlets and raw materials?

A. Formal independence vs effective autonomy B. Lenin C. Constraint vs disappearance D. Gauba's balanced appraisal

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210)**, with **Lenin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Kwame Nkrumah**?

A. domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210). B. relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state

ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF p.217). C. Nkrumah popularised and systematised neo-colonialism for an international audience in his 1965 book *Neo-colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism*, explaining how formal independence may coexist with continued external control through international monetary bodies, world-market price-fixing, multinational corporations/cartels, and educational-cultural institutions (PDF pp.211-212). D. a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Kwame Nkrumah** with **Nkrumah popularised and systematised neo-colonialism for an international audience in his 1965 book *Neo-colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism*, explaining how formal independence may coexist with continued external control through international monetary bodies, world-market price-fixing, multinational corporations/cartels, and educational-cultural institutions (PDF pp.211-212).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Who popularised and systematised the canonical 1965 account of neo-colonialism without safely being called the term's originator?

A. Legal sovereignty vs actual power B. Edward Said C. State D. Kwame Nkrumah

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Nkrumah popularised and systematised neo-colonialism for an international audience in his 1965 book *Neo-colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism*, explaining how formal independence may coexist with continued external control through international monetary bodies, world-market price-fixing, multinational corporations/cartels, and educational-cultural institutions (PDF pp.211-212).** with **Kwame Nkrumah**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Gauba's balanced appraisal**?

A. globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218). B. implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209). C. two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright. D. helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba's balanced appraisal** with **globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which position recognises both globalisation's communicative opportunities and its risks of domination and inequality?

A. Imperialism vs neo-colonialism B. Gauba's balanced appraisal C. J.A. Hobson D. Market

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218).** with **Gauba's balanced appraisal**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **State**?

A. formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212). B. the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212). C. Policy autonomy narrows under IMF/World Bank conditionality, WTO treaty commitments and delegated adjudicative procedures; regulatory functions may also be pooled in common institutions (PDF pp.216-217 for IMF/World Bank). D. interprets imperialism as a search for captive markets and attacks it as exploitation (PDF p.210).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **State** with **Policy autonomy narrows under IMF/World Bank conditionality, WTO treaty commitments and delegated adjudicative procedures; regulatory functions may also be pooled in common institutions (PDF pp.216-217 for IMF/World Bank)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which actor still authorises treaties, implements obligations and supplies territorial legal status under interdependence?

A. Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence B. Lenin C. Citizenship D. State

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Policy autonomy narrows under IMF/World Bank conditionality, WTO treaty commitments and delegated adjudicative procedures; regulatory functions may also be pooled in common institutions (PDF pp.216-217 for IMF/World Bank)** with **State**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Market**?

A. Production, capital and labour cross borders through MNCs, eroding a state's exclusive control over its own economic space (PDF pp.210-212, 214-217). B. Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214). C. already named in Gauba's neo-colonialism discussion as vehicles of capital investment, cheap-labour use and profit repatriation that narrow a developing state's practical economic autonomy even after formal independence (PDF pp.210-212). D. one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological, environmental and cultural linkage (PDF pp.212-218).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Market** with **Production, capital and labour cross borders through MNCs, eroding a state's exclusive control over its own economic space (PDF pp.210-212, 214-217)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which domain is transformed by cross-border production, capital and labour flows while remaining open to political regulation?

A. Globalization as process vs globalization as policy B. Market C. Kwame Nkrumah D. Imperialism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Production, capital and labour cross borders through MNCs, eroding a state's exclusive control over its own economic space (PDF pp.210-212, 214-217)** with **Market**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Citizenship**?

A. worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as a conscious policy linked to liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217). B. treaty negotiation and collective rule-making contain a pooled element, while authorising panels or adjudicators to apply agreed rules is a delegated element. Both rest on consented treaty commitments rather than unilateral external command. Verify the current operational status of particular dispute-settlement stages from an official WTO source before making a dated claim; do not present this illustration as a Gauba citation. C. Global communication, migration and transnational civil-society networks widen a citizen's frame of reference and rights-claims beyond the territorial state (synthesis, not a direct Gauba citation). D. Gauba treats interdependence as an emerging reality and also describes policy globalization as a deliberate extension of liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Citizenship** with **Global communication, migration and transnational civil-society networks widen a citizen's frame of reference and rights-claims beyond the territorial state (synthesis, not a direct Gauba citation)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which status remains mainly guaranteed territorially even as communication and migration widen rights-claims beyond borders?

A. Constraint vs disappearance B. Gauba's balanced appraisal C. Colonialism D. Citizenship

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Global communication, migration and transnational civil-society networks widen a citizen's frame of reference and rights-claims beyond the territorial state (synthesis, not a direct Gauba citation)** with **Citizenship**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ STATUS

No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic. Political Theory is a conceptual-support repository, and the source mapping expressly prohibits proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ routing. The questions below are therefore labelled as original practice, not PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish formal legal sovereignty from effective autonomy under globalisation. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Formal legal sovereignty and effective autonomy answer different questions about a state's external position.

Core analysis: Legal sovereignty means recognised independence and equality: no foreign state possesses lawful title to govern the territory. Effective autonomy concerns whether the state has the material, technological, financial and strategic capacity to make meaningful choices. Gauba's sequence from colonialism to neo-colonialism shows why the two can diverge. A post-colonial state may possess a flag, constitution and international personality while dependence on capital, markets, technology or security guarantees narrows its policy space.

Critical evaluation: External constraint is not automatically the same as legal subordination. Voluntary cooperation can enlarge capacity, whereas coercive dependence can hollow out nominal freedom. Analysis must therefore ask who sets the terms, whether alternatives exist and how costs are distributed.

Conclusion: Globalisation leaves juridical statehood intact while making effective autonomy a variable achievement shaped by material capacity, bargaining power and the terms of interdependence.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish imperialism, colonialism and neo-colonialism as challenges to sovereignty. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Imperialism, colonialism and neo-colonialism describe related but distinct mechanisms through which one political economy dominates another.

Core analysis: Following Edward Said's distinction, imperialism is the wider project of metropolitan domination, while colonialism is its settlement-based and directly territorial form. Colonial rule openly suppresses sovereignty through administration and extraction. Neo-colonialism persists after formal independence: external control works through trade structures, finance, technology, multinational corporations, pricing power and cultural institutions. Hobson interprets imperialism as exploitation in search of captive markets, Lenin links it structurally to capitalist expansion, and Nkrumah gives neo-colonial dependence its canonical modern formulation.

Critical evaluation: The concepts should not be collapsed into a slogan. Indirect influence varies in coerciveness, and every cross-border investment is not neo-colonial. The decisive test is whether formally sovereign choice is systematically subordinated by unequal structures.

Conclusion: The sequence moves from broad domination, through direct territorial rule, to formally independent but materially dependent statehood; legal decolonisation therefore does not guarantee substantive autonomy.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: How did power blocs constrain sovereignty, and what was the political significance of non-alignment? Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Cold War power blocs constrained sovereignty by making the security of weaker states dependent on rival superpower camps.

Core analysis: Military alliances, ideological rivalry and external guarantees narrowed foreign-policy choice even where territorial independence remained legally intact. Alignment could supply protection but also create pressure over bases, diplomacy, armament and development priorities. Non-alignment under leaders such as Nehru, Nasser and Tito was therefore not passive neutrality. It attempted to preserve sovereign judgment, resist automatic camp discipline and create collective bargaining space for newly independent states.

Further development: The mechanism ran from security vulnerability to alliance dependence and then to expectations of diplomatic or military conformity. Non-alignment tried to interrupt that chain through issue-based judgment and post-colonial collective action. It was not equal distance on every dispute, and its success varied with capacity and regional conflict.

Critical evaluation: Non-alignment did not eliminate material asymmetry, and states often had to cooperate selectively with both blocs. Its significance was normative and strategic: it asserted that juridically equal states should possess practical room to judge issues on their merits rather than inherit another power's enemies.

Conclusion: Bloc politics narrowed strategic choice without abolishing statehood, while non-alignment asserted that weaker states could preserve decision-space through organised autonomy rather than compulsory camp membership.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Explain globalisation as both a process and a policy, with reference to pooled and delegated sovereignty. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Globalisation is both an objective intensification of cross-border interdependence and a policy project that deliberately liberalises markets and reallocates regulatory authority.

Core analysis: As process, it connects production, finance, communication, culture and environmental consequences across borders. As policy, liberalisation and privatisation encourage cross-border movement of capital, technology, labour and goods. States pool authority through joint institutional decisions and delegate defined adjudicative, administrative or monitoring functions to treaty bodies. Loan conditionality is different: it is consented external constraint, not performance of a sovereign function on the borrower's behalf. Legal title persists, although practical discretion becomes shared or narrowed.

Further development: The distinction clarifies responsibility. Technological or ecological interdependence is not fully chosen, whereas liberalisation, treaty accession and conditional borrowing are open to democratic scrutiny. Pooling can add collective leverage and delegation can add expertise; conditional lending remains a separate bargaining constraint. Each becomes problematic when accountability is bypassed or exit is only formal.

Critical evaluation: Formal consent may conceal unequal bargaining power where finance or market access leaves few alternatives. Pooling, delegation and conditional constraint therefore describe different transformations whose legitimacy depends on reciprocity, accountability and meaningful review or exit.

Conclusion: Globalisation transforms sovereignty through consented but unequal institutional constraints; pooling and delegation describe altered exercises of authority, not the automatic extinction of legal title.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Has globalisation ended sovereignty? Evaluate the hyperglobalist, sceptic and transformationalist positions. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The claim that globalisation has ended sovereignty confuses the erosion of insulation with the disappearance of legally and politically organised state authority.

Core analysis: Hyperglobalists emphasise global markets, mobile capital, communication networks and transnational governance that displace national control. Sceptics answer that international trade and regional concentration are not wholly new, that states create the rules and that national institutions remain decisive. Transformationalists reject both extremes: globalisation reconstitutes functions, capacities and sites of decision through multilevel authority, pooled institutions and uneven networks. Gauba's balanced account is closest to this view because he calls for revision of external sovereignty rather than announcing its death.

Further development: The 15 July 2026 entry into force of the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement offers a current conceptual anchor. The agreement creates new market-access and regulatory commitments because two sovereign governments negotiated and accepted common rules. It therefore illustrates both persistence and transformation: state consent remains constitutive, but future policy choices operate inside a denser framework. The example cannot establish that every trade agreement is equal or beneficial; distributional effects, safeguards, domestic implementation and parliamentary scrutiny, and the practical costs of withdrawal remain separate empirical questions.

Critical evaluation: States still tax, legislate, enforce rights, represent populations and authorise treaties, but they do so under unequal interdependence. The relevant question is therefore which powers are retained, shared or effectively lost, and whether the new arrangements remain democratically answerable.

Conclusion: The transformationalist judgment is strongest: states remain indispensable legal and political actors, but their capacities, functions and decision-sites are reconstituted through uneven transnational interdependence.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Is globalisation merely a new form of neo-colonialism? Critically discuss. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Globalisation can operate through neo-colonial structures, but the two concepts are not identical.

Core analysis: The neo-colonial thesis explains how formally independent states remain dependent through finance, adverse trade terms, multinational corporations, technology and cultural power. Globalisation can deepen these mechanisms when powerful states and firms write rules, externalise risks and capture gains. Yet global interdependence also permits knowledge diffusion, new markets, transnational advocacy and coalitions among developing countries. OPEC and non-alignment illustrate the possibility of collective resistance, while treaty institutions can constrain powerful states as well as weaker ones when rules are reciprocal.

Further development: Three tests sharpen the verdict. First, authorship: did weaker parties participate meaningfully in framing the rule? Second, distribution: are gains, risks and adjustment costs shared or extracted asymmetrically? Third, agency: can affected states build capacity, form coalitions and revise commitments? Where these fail, globalisation reproduces neo-colonial dependence behind formal consent. Where they are present, interdependence may be negotiated cooperation. The neo-colonial lens is therefore indispensable for exposing power, but insufficient if it treats every institution and flow as unilateral domination.

Critical evaluation: The correct judgment is institutional and distributive rather than semantic. Globalisation becomes neo-colonial where consent is nominal, alternatives absent and benefits systematically extracted. It is cooperative where rule-making is inclusive, obligations reciprocal and weaker participants gain real capacity.

Conclusion: Globalisation can reproduce neo-colonial asymmetry, yet it also creates reciprocal institutions, new coalitions and shared capacities; the answer depends on who authors the rules, distributes gains and retains meaningful exit.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.